IPX Awareness Campaign — $5,000 Test Flight

Paid social + search + one creator · 6 weeks · pre-launch demand test

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$5,000 BUDGET **6-WEEK FLIGHT**

What $5,000 actually buys. At roughly $119/day, this budget cannot buy a launch — spread across three platforms, none would ever exit the learning phase. So it is deliberately concentrated, and its job is different: **buy a defensible answer to "does this message convert this audience at a price the business can afford?"** The media is the experiment; the finding is the deliverable.

OBJECTIVE & ASSUMPTIONS

Prove qualified-lead economics on the highest-value segment before anyone commits a launch budget. Awareness is the by-product; the measurable output is verified interest at a known cost.

- **Budget:** $5,000 total
- **Flight:** 6 weeks, back-loaded
- **Market:** US only (SEC-compliant)
- **Daily:** ~$119 blended

WHERE THE $5,000 GOES

CHANNEL	ROLE	BUDGET
Meta — Facebook & IG 45–65+ primary, retargeting from wk 3	Only platform that reaches the highest-capital segment at scale, and the best optimiser at low spend	**$2,900** 58%
Google Search brand defence + 6–8 high-intent terms	Catches the demand the social spend creates; brand terms are cheap insurance	**$1,100** 22%
One micro-creator usage rights + whitelisting	Bought as a **creative asset**, not reach — runs inside the Meta budget	**$600** 12%
Held reserve released at the week-3 gate	Deployed only to a proven winner — never pre-committed	**$400** 8%

Why no TikTok. Adding a third platform would split roughly $40/day three ways. Platform algorithms need about 50 conversions per week per ad set to leave the learning phase; at that spend none of them would, and I would be paying full price for unoptimised delivery on all three. **Concentration is not a preference here, it is the only way the budget works.**

HOW I GET THERE

→ **Optimise to the deepest event the data allows.** Weeks 1–2 optimise to landing-page view to gather signal cheaply, then switch to the lead event once ~50/week is achievable. Optimising to a deep event too early starves delivery.

→ **One audience, not five.** A single 45–65+ interest-and-lookalike set, plus retargeting. Narrow beats broad when there is no budget to explore.

→ **Creative is the variable I actually control.** Two messages × three executions, refreshed once at week 3. Creative drives most of the performance variance at this size, not bidding.

→ **Back-loaded pacing.** ~30% in weeks 1–2, ~35% weeks 3–4, ~35% weeks 5–6 — intent decays, so the heaviest spend sits closest to launch.

NORTH-STAR METRIC

≤ $58 / qualified lead

Not a round number — it is the modelled maximum bid for a reservation-grade lead ($80.60 target CAC × 72% probability of funding). **Above it, this budget is buying leads the business cannot profitably serve.**

KPIS, TARGETS & BENCHMARKS

METRIC	TARGET	BENCHMARK
AWARDNESS		
Impressions	**160–290K**	—
CPM (Meta, 45+)	**$12–18**	fintech US $9–20
ENGAGEMENT		
Link CTR	**0.8–1.5%**	cold social 0.5–1.2%
Cost / landing-page view	**$1.75–3.00**	finance $2–4
LP → email conversion	**8–12%**	new category 5–10%
QUALIFIED INTEREST		
Email → verified rate	**30–40%**	waitlist norm 20–35%
Qualified leads (verified)	**60–90**	—
Cost / qualified lead	**$55–85**	cap $58
Founding Member reservations	**12–20**	—

TWO THINGS I WANT ON THE RECORD

! **The plan sits at the edge of viability by design.** The expected CPQL range straddles the $58 cap. That is the honest read at $5K, and it is the question worth answering.

! **Ad-platform certification is week-one work.** Meta and Google pre-certify financial advertisers; the creator post is a paid testimonial for a security, not a standard #ad. That gating slips flights more often than creative does.

At $50K I would be buying a pipeline. At **$5K I am buying a decision** *— whether this audience, on this message, produces reservation-grade interest below its bid cap. A clean no is worth the budget; an expensive maybe is not.*

IPX

Measurement, Decisions & Adjustment

How performance is judged, what triggers a change, and what I would change first

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DIAGNOSING A PROBLEM BEFORE FIXING IT

Most underperforming campaigns get "fixed" at the wrong layer — new audiences bolted on when the creative was the problem. I work the funnel top-down and change **one layer at a time**, because fixing two things at once means learning nothing from either.

CTR below 0.7% Nobody is stopping	**Creative, not targeting.** The message is failing to earn attention. Swap executions before touching the audience.
CTR fine, cost/LPV above $4 They click, they don't land	**Page speed or a promise mismatch.** The ad is writing a cheque the landing page isn't cashing.
LPV fine, email conv. below 6% They read, they don't sign up	**The offer.** What we're asking for is worth less than what we're asking them to give.
Emails fine, verified below 25% They sign up, they don't verify	**Audience quality.** We bought curiosity, not intent. Narrow targeting and move the optimisation event deeper.
Every stage healthy, CPQL above $58 It works, it just costs too much	**Economics, not execution.** Nothing tactical fixes this. Escalate the finding rather than spend the remainder.

RULES I SET BEFORE SPENDING, NOT AFTER

- → **Pause any ad** under 0.5% CTR after 1,000 impressions, or above $4 per landing-page view after $150 spend.
- → **Winners are chosen on cost per qualified lead**, never cost per click or per email — the cheapest lead is usually the least valuable one.
- → **Reallocate no more than 20% of budget per week**, once weekly. Larger or more frequent shifts reset the algorithm's learning and cost more than they save.
- → **No structural change inside a 72-hour window** unless spend is running away — daily numbers at this budget are noise, not signal.

THREE GATES, THREE REAL DECISIONS

GATE 1 · END OF WEEK 2 · $1,500 SPENT
Question: is anyone engaging? **Pass:** CTR ≥0.8% and cost/LPV ≤$3. **If it fails** I rebuild creative rather than add budget — spending more against a message that isn't landing just buys the same failure at scale.

GATE 2 · END OF WEEK 4 · $3,300 SPENT
Question: does engagement become verified intent? **Pass:** CPQL ≤$70 and falling. **If it fails** I cut to the single best-performing segment and switch entirely to retargeting, accepting lower volume to protect cost per lead.

GATE 3 · WEEK 5 · THE STOP RULE
Question: can this clear its bid cap? **If CPQL is still above $58 with no downward trend,** my recommendation is to stop and return the remaining spend rather than finish the flight. Knowing at $3,300 that the model doesn't work is worth more than a completed report that says the same thing at $5,000.

WHAT SUCCESS ACTUALLY MEANS HERE

- → **Did it produce qualified leads?** Volume against the 60–90 target.
- → **At a price the business can afford?** CPQL against the $58 cap — the only pass/fail number on the page.
- → **Did it de-risk the next budget?** A winning message, a winning segment, and a real CPM/CTR/conversion baseline to plan against. **At $5K this is the most valuable output**, because it is the part that makes a $50K ask defensible instead of speculative.

A campaign that returns 60 leads at $54 and a proven message is a success. One that returns 200 leads at $95 is a failure with good-looking topline numbers — **and I would report it as one.**

Every rule here is written down ***before*** *the money moves. Thresholds set in advance are judgement; thresholds set after seeing the numbers are just justification.*